ELDERS QUORUM & RELIEF SOCIETY · 25 MIN

Sealed by the Holy Spirit of Promise

Elder David A. Bednar · October 2026 general conference

Weekly 25-minute meeting (since Sept. 6, 2026). Begin and end with prayer, start the discussion quickly, and counsel together during the lesson. There is no separate counseling topic beforehand.

ONE CORE TRUTH

Ordinances and covenants are spiritual credentials — kept faithfully, they are sealed by the Holy Spirit of Promise.

0:00–2:00 — **Welcome & prayer · Presidency**

- A simple welcome, then invite someone to give the opening prayer.
- Keep business to what can't wait; no separate counseling topic. Then start right away.

2:00–5:00 — **Open · Teacher**

- Ask: Am I keeping my covenant “credentials” valid — and what would help me honor my temple covenants more faithfully?
- Invite someone to read: “For disciples of Jesus Christ, receiving priesthood ordinances and entering into sacred covenants are essential steps in the ‘quest of a lifetime’ to align our hearts, minds, and lives with God’s will.”
- Give a quiet moment to ponder before anyone answers.

5:00–20:00 — **Discuss one core truth · Everyone**

- Q1. Read Doctrine and Covenants 132:7 together. How does it help us understand this truth about following Jesus Christ?
- Q2. When have you seen this truth at work in your own life or family?
- Optional, about 3 min: Turn to someone nearby and share your answer to Q2, then invite two or three people to share with everyone.
- Q3. What challenges or opportunities in our ward does this speak to? How could we help one another, including through our ministering and in our homes?
- Let members answer one another. Resist answering every question yourself.

20:00–24:00 — **Invite, testify, follow up · Teacher**

- From the talk: Honor your covenants and press forward in faith so your ordinances can be sealed by the Holy Spirit of Promise.
- Ask: “What do you feel impressed to do?” Give a minute to write it down privately.
- Bear brief testimony of Jesus Christ and this truth, or invite someone to.
- Next week, open by inviting one or two people to share how it went.

24:00–25:00 — **Closing prayer · Presidency**

- Invite someone to give the closing prayer. End on time.

BEFORE SUNDAY

Speaking about ordinances and covenants, with a focus on the sealing ordinance. A covenant is a solemn promise and enduring commitment between God and His children, received through sacred ordinances — holy acts performed by priesthood authority with spiritual purpose and eternal significance. Understanding ordinances helps us understand our covenants. Covenants and ordinances are spiritual credentials, and faithfulness keeps them valid to receive the promised blessings. The Holy Ghost is the Holy Spirit of Promise, who ratifies righteous acts as acceptable to God; during mortality that seal is conditional and can be forfeited through unrighteousness. The temple sealing of a man and a woman is a crowning covenant and ordinance; a spouse who violates covenants and does not repent loses the ratifying seal, while a faithful spouse who honors covenants and presses forward in faith remains worthy to receive the promised blessings.

- Read the full talk and pray about what your quorum or Relief Society needs from it.
- Share the talk link a few days early so members come having read it.
- Teach one truth well. Meaningful discussion matters more than covering everything.
- Other scriptures the talk cites: Moses 7:21; Doctrine and Covenants 136:4; Doctrine and Covenants 64:31–32; Mosiah 2:41

Timing follows the Church's 25-minute meeting guidance; adapt it as the Spirit directs. Read the full talk at ChurchofJesusChrist.org.